

Blueair 280i

We've been testing out many air purifiers and the ones offering Wi-Fi connectivity along with a companion app have always been appreciated. The Blueair Classic 280i is meant for room sizes of 280 sq. ft. It's capable of filtering out smoke, dust and pollen from the air inside your house. The smart panel on the top displays a lot of functions such as Wi-Fi connectivity, fan speed status, filter status and the air quality of the room for PM2.5 and VOC levels. The most interesting feature in the 'i' models is the presence of an air quality sensor that speeds up the fans whenever it detects a drop in the air quality in the room. We tested this out by blowing smoke near the purifier and it switched to the auto mode until it brought back the air quality to normal.

The purifier takes in air from the back and blows out clean and purified air from the top. It's necessary to place the purifier away from any kind of hindrance to the air flow. You can either set the purifier in the automatic mode or switch between the three fan speeds. The Blueair Friend app will let you control all the modes remotely without touching the purifier, and it's available on both Android and iOS. You can also monitor the air quality of your room in real-time and accordingly set the fan speed. The app also connects to a database that gives you the air quality of over 150 countries, possibly including your city. When the filter wears out over time, the Filter indicator will let you know that it's time to replace the filter. With all the features mentioned above, the Blueair 280i does justify its price of ₹55,000 considering app connectivity and the presence of the air quality sensor.

SPECIFICATIONS

Room size: 280 sq. ft. (room size is based on 8' ceiling) | **CADR (Smoke):** 180 ft³ per minute | **CADR (Dust):** 200 ft³ per minute | **CADR (Pollen):** 200 ft³ per minute | **Air changes per hour:** 5 | **Dimensions (H x W x D):** 533 x 432 x 209 mm (21 x 17 x 9 in) | **Product weight:** 11 kg (35 lb)



SECURITY WATCH

Chrome and Firefox Phishing attack

A phishing attack occurs when an attacker sends you an email or message containing a link to a website that looks trustworthy. Clicking the link may infect your system or fool you into logging into the website.



This particular type of phishing attack is using unicode to register

domains that look identical to the actual domain. The prefix being used is what is known as an 'ASCII compatible encoding' prefix. This lets the browser know that the domain is using 'punycode' encoding to represent the Unicode characters.

The attack only seems to affect Chrome and Firefox users, and should be patched by the time you read this.

Google Play Flashlight Trojan

ESET researchers recently discovered a banking trojan on Google Play disguised as a flashlight widget. The malware was found masquerading as a flashlight app on Google Play. After being downloaded and installed, it would ask for admin rights, hide its icon, and appear



on the phone only as a widget. It could then display fake screens and mimic legit apps, lock devices to prevent detection, and intercept SMSes and display fake notifications. It was targeted at primarily banking apps.

It was detected by ESET as Trojan.

Android/Charger.B and was pulled from the store on April 10. If you haven't downloaded any flashlight apps of late you should be fine. If you did download something that displayed similar characteristics as the one above – and are infected – the only way to uninstall it will be to boot the device in safe mode and then do so.

US Law enforcement hits Kelihos/Waledac botnet

Peter Levashov, who according to the FBI, is the alleged mastermind behind the Kelihos/Waledac botnet, has been recently arrested in Spain. According to the FBI, Kelihos is, "one of the world's most notorious criminal spammers."

Kelihos has been active since 2008 and has since been under attack many times before resurfacing later. It has appeared to have gone silent after the current operation but one cannot tell for sure whether it's gone for good. This is the same botnet responsible for the W32.Waledac viruses you may have encountered on your PC. It functioned by sending spam emails pretending to be from legit sources luring people into giving up their credentials.